

Contact

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(LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Law, Regulation, and Compliance
Compliance Management
Business Ethics

Languages

English

Certifications

The Data Scientist's Toolbox
Quantitative Methods
Journalism, the future, and you!
Data Science @Cisco Generative AI
Green Belt 2024

Tim Shores

I make complex systems legible and trapped knowledge valuable
Leverett, Massachusetts, United States

Summary

Most useful information is stuck. It's in people's heads, buried in systems nobody reads, jargon nobody outside the room understands, or data waiting to be shaped into a decision.

I've spent my career finding it and making it useful.

At Cisco, that means content strategy and information architecture for security products, making sure customers can find and act on what they need. Before that, it meant building databases of European Parliament voting patterns for a forest policy campaign, designing donor data systems and writing program concept notes for a Haiti-focused nonprofit, and constructing the knowledge base that cut support call volume by 20% at a software company.

Outside work, I serve on a planning board and two school committees in Western Massachusetts and on the board of The MPOWER Project. Municipal budgets, policy, and community needs all hold trapped knowledge, and the value comes when it's made legible to the people making decisions about them.

My range of work is deliberate. Illegible complexity shows up everywhere, and the work of solving it transfers across contexts more than people expect.

I use AI tools regularly, alongside Python and open-source data, as part of how I think about making institutional knowledge accessible at scale. I'm interested in what becomes possible when these tools are guided by someone who understands information architecture and human decision-making.

Experience

Cisco

4 years 1 month

Technical Education Content Developer

May 2024 - Present (1 year 10 months)

Researching and delivering Cisco Secure Access technical documentation in collaboration with product, engineering, and UX teams. Facilitating UX research and content design projects in 20+ quarterly sprints in alignment with research-driven customer outcomes and product team goals.

Researched and wrote Cisco Assistant LLM feature documentation for Secure Access and collaborated on a hackathon proof-of-concept demonstrating LLM generation of dynamic, user identity-based Cisco technical content.

Technical Communications Specialist

February 2022 - May 2024 (2 years 4 months)

Duo customer communications lead and content researcher for the Cisco Security Documentation team.

My responsibilities included:

- Research and design thinking in support of tech docs content and publishing ops
- Comms planning to connect cybersecurity product customers with the information they need about product changes, vulnerabilities, and recommended or required actions
- Product release notes covering every sprint
- Monitoring, assessment, and process improvement of our comms process
- Research and design thinking in support of branching the heartwarming Duo comms process to other Cisco Security products and services

To get this done, I:

- Facilitated discussion with SMEs from design, engineering, and product management
- Wrote technically accurate and transparent content with a customer-first mindset
- Drew constructive attention to content performance, knowledge-centered service, and product adoption outcomes
- Coordinated customer communication impact studies with Product and Data Science teams

I also mentor early-career coworkers and students.

Town Common Research

Researcher

January 2022 - August 2023 (1 year 8 months)

Leverett

Community-based participatory research, Age-Friendly needs assessment data collection and reporting, Collaborating for Equity & Justice, and other services in support of towns and community organizers who work to manage knowledge that is evidence-based and community-driven.

Partnership for Policy Integrity

Forest Policy Campaign Researcher

October 2019 - January 2023 (3 years 4 months)

Working to defend forests.

I managed the campaign website, participated in outreach, and conducted research and writing in support of the Forest Defenders Alliance campaign to rid the European Union Renewable Energy Directive of forest biomass, and stop counting wood burning toward emissions reduction targets.

I also collected data and developed a database of Ministers of European Parliament, their party and committee memberships, and their voting patterns with respect to forests and environmental policies, to support campaign monitoring and outreach.

<https://forestdefenders.eu/>

Hope for Haiti

Director of Data & Donor Experience

August 2019 - February 2022 (2 years 7 months)

Leverett, MA

Hope for Haiti's Mission Statement: To improve the quality of life for the Haitian people, particularly children.

My responsibilities: Revenue data management; Grantwriting and grant pipeline management; Donor services and support.

VentureWell

Platform Analyst

November 2016 - August 2019 (2 years 10 months)

Hadley, MA

- Nonprofit working to cultivate early stage ventures to commercialize high-impact STEM innovations.
- The Information Systems team collaborates to evaluate, design, and implement solutions for: Programmatic community building and network weaving; impact evaluation and program monitoring; grants management; funder, investor, and program participant relationship management; digital marketing; event management.
- I was the first responder for Salesforce development planning and implementation, and the second-tier resource for user support and training.
- I worked with the following platform components: Salesforce Community, Pardot, Service Cloud, Process Builder and Flow, Apex triggers and classes, Lightning Web Components, Nonprofit Success Pack, TaskRay.
- I worked with the following third-party tools: Skuid, RForcecom and RStudio, NetSuite integration via SOAP API, Form Assembly, Adobe Sign, Conga Composer, WordPress, Node.js.

Not1More

Program Lead, Tech, Innovation, & Coalition Development

August 2015 - August 2019 (4 years 1 month)

Leverett, MA

- Global environmental justice charity, campaign and coalition-builder committed to supporting and advocating for frontline environmental defenders facing reprisals, environmental conflict, and other atmospheres of violence.
- I designed and supported technology solutions in support of, or for remote deployment with, researchers and defenders working in remote forest sites. Technical solutions include app integrations, data collection design, data analysis, CRM development, web development, digital marketing, project planning and management, technical fundraising development, business partnership development, organizational strategy.
- I facilitated and collaborated on synthesis and strategy of social innovation, writing for funding development and marketing, and I seek and build mutually beneficial coalition relationships, in support of the N1M mission.
- Programs under development and in pilot included: Forest Threat Sensor (a peer to peer alerting, monitoring, and mapping system for frontline defenders encountering risk of violence), TIRTL (a rights violation documentation and reporting system), DefenderDirect (direct giving fundraising for forest defenders).
- Programs implemented and supported: Forest Defenders Conference, in its third year; I am Chut Wutty documentary film and associated advocacy and fundraising campaigns; Bloodwood campaign and report on unauthorized

plunder of Rosewood timber in Guinea-Bissau; Amazon Security Framework, a community of practice supporting frontline environmental defenders under threat in the Amazon; Defend the Defenders Coalition, network weaving among multiple learning organizations in dialogue on bridging gaps between environmental defenders and resources.

Computer Courage

IT Services Manager

January 2013 - November 2014 (1 year 11 months)

Berkeley, CA

- Small business IT service provider and web developer.
- Led a team of 5 to 7 technicians in service to 150 business customers. Personally closed 30 contracts by analyzing business goals, writing crisp proposals, project plans, and budgets, showing up for customer priorities, demonstrating empathy for customer concerns, and exceeding expectations with technically skilful, reliable, professional service.
- Collaborated with the President on business innovations: CRM practices and software, modular project management templates, project cost forecasting, annual service contracts, client IT inventories, service outcome evaluations, customer satisfaction evaluation, team-building events, 'balanced scorecard' KPI monitoring and KPI change case studies.

DOMICO Software

Production Manager and Senior Database Specialist

June 2006 - January 2013 (6 years 8 months)

Oakland, CA

- Veteran software development company specializing in the self-storage subsector of real estate.
- Collaborated on a small team of support technicians and database software developers working with finance and management clientele to migrate data, customize and support software implementations, and develop and QA bug fixes and new features.
- Reduced support call volume 20% and improved resolution time 40% by mentoring technicians, writing and managing knowledge base, evangelizing process improvement and automation for QA, ETL migration, and SQL Server administration.

Borders Group Inc

Helpdesk Technician

January 1999 - September 2000 (1 year 9 months)

Ann Arbor, MI

Provided remote support of Windows NT and OS/2 systems connected by VSAT for Borders and Waldenbooks stores. Applications included email, inventory, and POS.

Education

University of Michigan

BGS, Linguistics, Literature, Philosophy · (1998 - 2004)

University of Massachusetts Amherst

Graduate Certificate, Data Analytics and Computational Social Science (DACSS) · (November 2022 - December 2024)

Coursera & Johns Hopkins Bloomberg School of Public Health

Specialization, Data Science · (2013 - 2015)